

The Rising Solent, the Shifting Deck

Edition 2 in the Royal Southern Yacht Club series. Previous Decision Intelligence report: 'Fixed Costs, Falling Tide' (May 2026).

Cycle: 30 July 2026 · Audience: Flag Officers, General

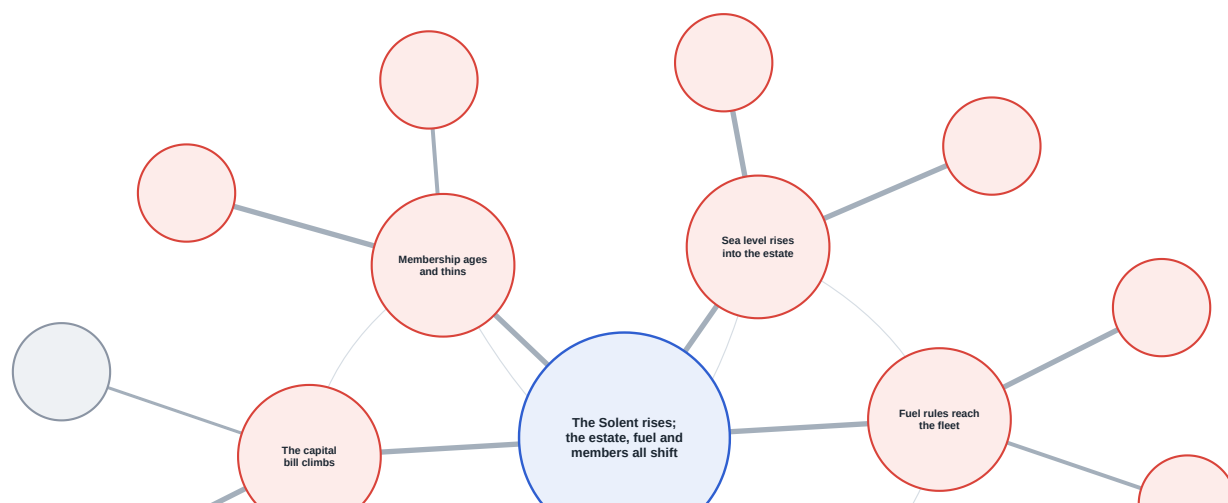
Committee and senior management · Horizon: to 2040

Read estimate: 3 min Executive Synthesis · 22 min full read

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○ risk ○ opportunity ○ mixed/neutral impact × likelihood: — high — med — low



What you'll learn

1. Why the ground under the estate is physically moving: sea-level rise and saltmarsh loss reshape the Hamble frontage to 2040, not in some distant future.
2. Why decarbonisation has already reached the fleet: red diesel has ended for propulsion, and the Club is being pulled toward becoming a fuel and charging provider.
3. Why the estate is becoming harder and dearer to insure: Flood Re exits in 2039, coastal erosion has no cover at all, and premiums and build costs are climbing together.
4. Why the membership base ages and thins toward 2040, and what a 2040-fit funnel, not a 2010 one, needs to look like.

Key takeaways

1. The Environment Agency's South East sea-level allowance is 261mm to the 2036-2065 window, and Solent saltmarsh has fallen below 1,400 hectares, more than half lost, exposing the Hamble estate's defences.
2. Diesel for propulsion now attracts the full 52.95 pence-a-litre rate, and the EU is steering the sector to a 90 percent emissions cut by 2040, so fuel and charging become a Club decision.
3. Flood Re is legislated to end in 2039 and excludes commercial property and coastal erosion entirely, while UK property claims hit a record 6.1 billion pounds in 2025 and building costs are forecast up 13.1 percent to 2031.
4. The RYA calls UK sailing "at a crossroads" with participation in decline, leisure spending fell 10.6 percent in Q4 2025, and only 44 percent of over-75s are active, squeezing the members' model to 2040.

Executive Synthesis

Why this matters now

The May cycle, "Fixed Costs, Falling Tide", read the Club's near-term squeeze: falling participation, an ageing model, a rising estate cost base. This edition lengthens the horizon to 2040 and finds three of those pressures hardening into the horizon and two new ones arriving. The ground under the estate is physically moving as the Solent rises and its saltmarsh buffer retreats; decarbonisation has already reached the fleet, with red diesel gone and the marina pulled toward energy provision; the estate grows harder and dearer to insure as Flood Re heads for its 2039 exit; and the membership base ages and thins beneath all of it. The through-line: to 2040 the estate, the fuel and the members all move at once.

Four shifts this cycle records, and the pattern that names them:

- **The estate is on moving ground.** Sea-level rise and saltmarsh loss reshape the Hamble frontage to 2040, turning flood risk and defences into a dated capital question.
- **The zero-carbon wake reaches the fleet.** Red diesel has ended for propulsion and the EU is steering a 90 percent cut by 2040, so fuel and charging become a Club decision, not a distant one.
- **The ground is becoming uninsurable at the edges.** Flood Re exits in 2039, coastal erosion has no cover, and premiums and build costs climb together.
- **The membership thins and ages.** Participation is in decline and discretionary spend is under pressure, so the 2040 funnel has to be rebuilt for a different demographic.

This cycle names the variable that will decide the Club's position in 2040: not whether these forces are real, the evidence settles that, but whether the Club adapts the estate, the energy offer and the membership funnel on a planned timetable, or lets a moving seascape set the timetable for it. Four developments carry the pattern.

First, the estate sits on moving ground. The Environment Agency's climate-change allowance puts sea level for the South East, which includes the Solent, some [261mm higher](#) by the 2036-2065 window, and the Climate Change Committee projects [roughly 8 million English properties at flood risk by 2050](#). The saltmarsh that buffers the Hamble

frontage has fallen [below 1,400 hectares](#), more than half its pre-1940s extent, with a restoration [trial](#) now under way at Hackett's Marsh. Along comparable western-Solent shoreline the Agency projects properties at risk rising [from 35 today to 360 within a century](#). For the Club this is a dated adaptation task, not a distant risk.

Second, the zero-carbon wake has reached the recreational fleet. Diesel used to propel private pleasure craft now attracts the [full 52.95 pence-a-litre rate](#), some 46 pence a litre above the old rebated rate, and suppliers must collect a [propulsion declaration](#). Europe's boating industry ties the sector to the [EU's 90 percent emissions-cut target for 2040](#), and the [EU Sustainable Transport Investment Plan](#) now includes recreational craft. Charging is arriving, with [the Electric Seaway now serving Solent sites at Southampton, Lymington and Chichester](#), so the marina is being pulled toward becoming an energy provider even as the fleet turns over only about 2 percent a year.

Third, the ground grows harder to insure at its edges. [Flood Re is legislated to end in 2039](#), and it excludes commercial property; a Commons committee confirms there is [no specific insurance for coastal erosion](#) at all. UK property insurers paid a [record 6.1 billion pounds](#) in 2025 and average buildings cover rose [10 percent to 322 pounds a year](#), while the [EU insurance protection gap sits near 75 percent](#). The estate is still insurable today, but the direction of travel to 2039 and beyond is clear.

Fourth, the membership base thins and ages beneath all of it. The RYA calls the sport [at a crossroads](#) with participation in decline, British Marine finds [13.2 million adults try boating in a year](#) but only a quarter of them returning three or more times, and Deloitte records [a second straight quarter of falling leisure spend](#). Activity falls sharply with age, with [just 44 percent of over-75s active](#). The 2040 funnel cannot be the 2010 one.

*The estate, the fuel and the membership are all moving at once,
and only one of the three keeps its own timetable.*

The historical rhyme worth holding is the Club's own estate history: the Hamble frontage, pontoons and slipways were built for a stable waterline and a growing, younger membership. To 2040 both assumptions weaken together, and the prudent posture is to treat estate adaptation, the energy transition and membership renewal as one connected capital and strategy programme rather than three separate committee items.

Where this analysis could be wrong

The most consequential assumption is that these forces compound to 2040 rather than resolving on their own. If national flood-defence investment reaches the Hamble frontage, if drop-in fuels such as HVO scale and spare the Club a charging build-out, and if the post-pandemic dip in participation reverses as the RYA's pathways mature, then the picture is a manageable set of upgrades rather than a wholesale re-set, and a lighter, staged response is right. The falsifiable tests: whether a funded shoreline scheme covers the Club's frontage before 2035; whether HVO reaches price parity and marina availability; and whether Club membership and the junior pipeline stabilise over two seasons. Signals to watch: a local coastal-strategy funding decision, an HVO parity milestone, and two seasons of membership and junior-intake data.

What this cycle establishes

1. **The moving estate, recorded.** Sea-level rise and saltmarsh loss make the Hamble frontage a dated capital task. The open variable is whether a funded shoreline scheme reaches the Club before 2035.
2. **The zero-carbon wake, recorded.** Red diesel has ended and charging is arriving. The open variable is whether HVO bridges the gap or a charging build-out becomes unavoidable.
3. **Uninsurable ground, recorded.** Flood Re exits in 2039 and erosion has no cover. The open variable is when risk-reflective pricing starts to bite the estate policy.
4. **The thinning membership, recorded.** Participation declines and spend is squeezed. The open variable is whether the RYA pathways and a rebuilt funnel stabilise the base.
5. **Name the pattern: the deck is shifting.** The estate, the fuel and the members move together to 2040, so the planning question shifts from whether to how fast and how funded.

Each is developed below, with a decision posture, in the four Strategic Implications.

Continuity ledger: how the May cycle's five forces have moved

The May edition, "Fixed Costs, Falling Tide", named five near-term pressures. Three have hardened, one is pending, and this cycle adds two forces the May read had not isolated: decarbonisation and the insurance retreat.

May force	Status	2040 read
Structural decline in UK sailing participation	CONFIRMED	The RYA now calls the sport at a crossroads ; decline is confirmed and carried into this cycle's membership theme.
The ageing members'-club model under cost pressure	CONFIRMED	Leisure spending fell 10.6 percent in Q4 2025 and activity drops steeply with age; the model's 2040 viability is the horizon question.
Rising cost base of the marine estate	ESCALATED	Building costs are forecast up 13.1 percent to 2031 , now compounded by an insurance retreat the May cycle had not isolated.
Coastal climate exposure of the Hamble estate	ESCALATED	The 261mm sea-level allowance and saltmarsh below 1,400 hectares move this from exposure to a live, dated adaptation task.
Volunteer capacity and the racing pipeline	PENDING	The RYA youth team and Female Futures Group are in train; the pipeline read carries to the next cycle.

Audience Snapshots

Four functional lenses on the same intelligence base. Each card names the shift and the single question this cycle puts to that part of the Club's leadership.

ESTATE & FACILITIES (HOUSE COMMITTEE / MARINA)

Are you maintaining the frontage you have, or adapting the frontage 2040 will hand you?

The shift: the Environment Agency's [261mm sea-level allowance](#) and saltmarsh [below 1,400 hectares](#) turn the Hamble frontage from a maintenance line into a dated adaptation project, with properties on comparable western-Solent shoreline projected to rise [from 35 to 360](#) within a century.

The question to brief: should we commission a to-2040 estate adaptation and capital plan for pontoons, slipways and defences, rather than renewing them to the old waterline?

MEMBERSHIP & FINANCE (TREASURER / MEMBERSHIP)

Is the funnel you fund built for the 2010 member, or the 2040 one?

The shift: the RYA calls the sport [at a crossroads](#) with participation in decline, British Marine finds only about [a quarter of triallists return](#) three or more times, and leisure spending fell [10.6 percent in Q4 2025](#).

The question to brief: should we rebuild the recruitment-to-retention funnel and reserves policy around an older, more cost-pressured 2040 membership rather than assuming the current base renews itself?

SAILING & RACING (SAILING COMMITTEE)

Is the pathway that fills your fleet keeping pace with a declining national pipeline?

The shift: the RYA is standing up a [British Sailing Youth Team](#) and a [Female Futures Group](#), but national participation is flat to falling and activity drops steeply with age, with only [44 percent of over-75s active](#).

The question to brief: should we tie the Club's junior, adult-returner and female pathways explicitly to the RYA programmes so the racing pipeline does not thin with the national one?

COMMERCIAL & EVENTS (GENERAL COMMITTEE)

Is the energy and insurance bill a cost line, or the next commercial offer?

The shift: red diesel for propulsion now attracts the [full 52.95 pence rate](#), marina charging is arriving via [the Electric Seaway](#), and the electric-boat market is projected to reach [14 billion dollars by 2030](#), even as Flood Re heads for its [2039 exit](#).

The question to brief: should we treat marina charging, low-carbon fuel and a re-underwritten estate policy as a commercial and events proposition, not only a compliance cost?

Themes

The cycle's signals are organised into four themes, ranked by impact on the Club's decisions.

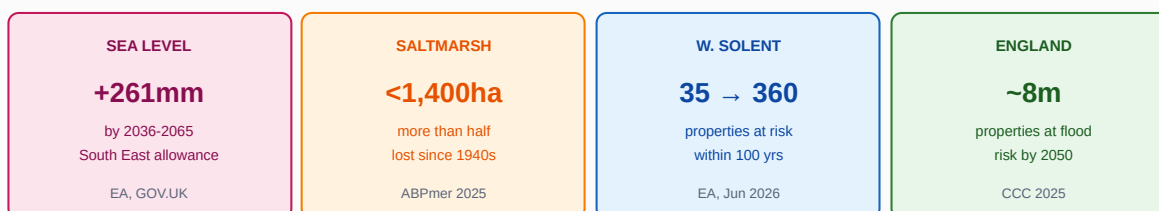
Immediate: shapes the next estate and capital-plan decisions. **Near-Term**: shapes position over the next few seasons. **Longer-Range**: a multi-year shift to track each cycle.

1. The Moving Estate: sea-level rise and saltmarsh loss reshape the Hamble shoreline to 2040

IMMEDIATE

The ground under the estate is physically moving. The Environment Agency's climate-change allowance puts South East sea level, which includes the Solent, some 261mm higher by the 2036-2065 epoch, and the Climate Change Committee projects roughly 8 million English properties at flood risk by 2050. The saltmarsh that buffers the Hamble frontage has fallen below 1,400 hectares, more than half its pre-1940s extent, and on comparable western-Solent shoreline the Agency projects properties at risk rising from 35 today to 360 within a century. For the Club this is a dated adaptation task on a fixed frontage, not a distant risk.

The moving estate, in four numbers



The moving-estate signal in four numbers. Source: Environment Agency, ABPmer/Solent Seascape, Climate Change Committee.

- The Environment Agency's higher-central allowance puts sea level for the South East river basin, which includes the Solent, about 261mm higher for the 2036-2065 epoch. [Environment Agency](#) (27 May 2022).
- The Climate Change Committee projects UK sea level around 10 to 30cm above the 1981-2000 baseline by 2050, with roughly 8 million English properties at flood risk by 2050. [Climate Change Committee](#) (30 April 2025).
- The Solent held over 3,000 hectares of saltmarsh before the 1940s but retains just under 1,400 today, more than half lost, with erosion continuing without intervention. [ABPmer for Solent Seascape](#) (28 February 2025).
- Natural England records 1,784 hectares of Solent saltmarsh lost, with UK saltmarshes eroding about 100 hectares a year and around 90 percent of loss unreplaced. [Natural England](#) (17 February 2022).
- Along the western Solent from Hurst Spit to Lymington the Agency projects properties at risk rising from 35 today to 360 within 100 years. [Environment Agency](#) (9 June 2026).
- At Hackett's Marsh on the River Hamble a restoration trial installed 107 coir rolls and over 330 stakes to slow saltmarsh erosion. [University of Portsmouth](#) (1 October 2024).

- The North Solent Shoreline Management Plan sets policy for the River Hamble across three epochs and warns rising sea levels raise flood and erosion risk. [North Solent SMP](#) (1 December 2010).
- The Tyndall Centre estimates 120,000 to 160,000 English coastal properties are at risk of relocation from sea-level rise from the 2050s. [Tyndall Centre](#) (15 June 2022).
- The Portsmouth tide gauge shows local sea-level rise accelerating from about 1.5mm a year in the early 20th century to over 3mm a year now. [Solent Forum](#) (evergreen).

Counter-argument

A funded shoreline scheme could reach the Hamble frontage before the risk bites. The Agency's record flood-defence investment and the Hurst-to-Lymington strategy show national money is moving, and a scheme covering the Club's frontage would convert a capital liability into a maintained asset. The falsifiable test is whether a funded coastal-defence scheme covers the Club's frontage before 2035. Actors to watch: the Environment Agency, New Forest and Eastleigh coastal partnerships, and the Solent Forum.

Weak signals to watch

- **WEAK SIGNAL** A single scheme could cover both saltmarsh restoration and hard defence at the frontage. Would gain weight if the Hackett's Marsh trial scales to a funded Hamble programme.
- **WEAK SIGNAL** Managed realignment could be proposed for stretches of the Hamble shoreline. Would gain weight if the next SMP review reclassifies frontage policy from hold-the-line.

Decision link: Strategic Implications [1](#) and [3](#).

2. The Zero-Carbon Wake: decarbonisation mandates reach the recreational fleet and the marina

NEAR-TERM

The zero-carbon wake has reached the recreational fleet. Diesel used to propel private pleasure craft now attracts the full 52.95 pence-a-litre rate, some 46 pence above the old rebated rate, and suppliers must collect a propulsion declaration. Europe's boating industry ties the sector to the EU's 90 percent emissions-cut target for 2040, and the EU Sustainable Transport Investment Plan now includes recreational craft for the first time. Charging is arriving on the Solent, so the marina is being pulled toward becoming an energy provider even as the fleet itself turns over only slowly.

The zero-carbon wake, in four numbers



The decarbonisation signal in four numbers. Source: HMRC, European Boating Industry, British Marine, Grand View Research.

- Diesel to propel private pleasure craft can no longer take a reduced rate and is charged at the full 52.95 pence-a-litre white-diesel rate. [HM Revenue & Customs](#) (7 July 2026).
- Fuel suppliers must collect a propulsion declaration and charge the white-diesel rate, with the change confirmed for pleasure craft including superyachts. [British Marine](#) (23 June 2026).
- The EBI roadmap ties Europe's roughly 6.5 million recreational vessels and its marinas to the EU's 90 percent GHG-reduction target for 2040. [European Boating Industry](#) (1 May 2026).
- The EU Sustainable Transport Investment Plan is the first EU transport strategy to include recreational craft, backing a technology-neutral fuel and infrastructure pathway. [European Boating Industry](#) (6 November 2025).
- ICOMIA's lifecycle study finds sustainable marine fuels could decarbonise recreational boats by as much as 90 percent by 2035, faster than fleet electrification. [ICOMIA](#) (15 November 2023).
- The RYA states HVO cuts CO2 by around 90 percent but is currently dearer than mineral diesel and limited in marina availability. [Royal Yachting Association](#) (9 May 2025).
- Marina DC fast chargers can deliver up to 360kW and an 80 percent charge in about 20 minutes, versus 8 to 10 hours for a full AC charge. [British Marine](#) (5 September 2024).
- The global electric-boat market was about 6.78 billion dollars in 2024 and is projected to reach 14.09 billion by 2030, a 13.5 percent CAGR from 2025 to 2030. [Grand View Research](#) (1 June 2025).

2025).

- Drop-in fuels cut emissions 40 to 90 percent by boat type, while over half a new boat's carbon footprint is embedded in build, per the METSTRADE briefing. [METSTRADE / ICOMIA](#) (25 March 2025).
- France's Nautic Forum, on 28 and 29 May 2026, frames propulsion electrification, eco-design and composite recycling as sector priorities. [BoatIndustry.fr](#) (16 May 2026).
- The 3.2 million pound UK Electric Seaway completed eight rapid electric-boat charging sites, including Southampton, Lymington and Chichester on the Solent. [Plugboats](#) (28 April 2025).

Counter-argument

Drop-in fuels such as HVO could spare the Club a charging build-out. If HVO reaches price parity and marina availability, the fleet decarbonises through the existing bowser rather than a capital charging programme, and the Club's role stays that of a fuel reseller. The falsifiable test is whether HVO reaches price parity and reliable Solent supply before 2030. Actors to watch: the RYA, British Marine, and Solent marina fuel suppliers.

Weak signals to watch

- **WEAK SIGNAL** The propulsion-fuel declaration regime could tighten into per-berth reporting. Would gain weight if HMRC extends record-keeping duties to marina berth-holders.
- **WEAK SIGNAL** A charging build-out could become a members' expectation, not an option. Would gain weight if a neighbouring Solent marina markets fast charging as a berth benefit.

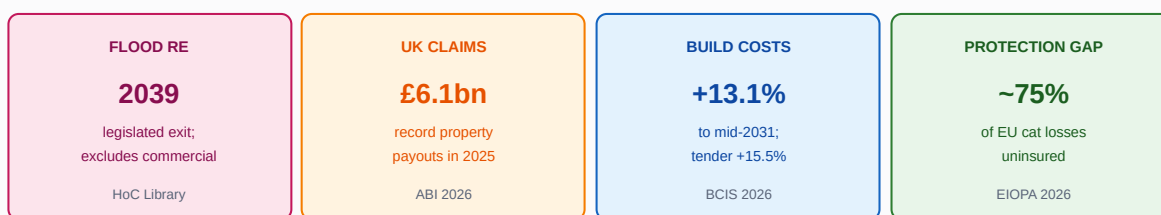
Decision link: Strategic Implication [2](#).

3. Uninsurable Ground: coastal-flood insurance retreats as the estate's capital bill climbs to 2040

NEAR-TERM

The ground grows harder and dearer to insure at its edges. Flood Re is legislated to end in 2039 and excludes commercial property, and a Commons committee confirms there is no specific insurance for coastal erosion at all. UK property insurers paid a record 6.1 billion pounds in 2025, average buildings cover has risen, and building costs are forecast up 13.1 percent to 2031, so the estate's capital and insurance bill climbs together. The estate is still insurable today, but the direction of travel to 2039 and beyond is a board-level financial question.

Uninsurable ground, in four numbers



The insurance-retreat signal in four numbers. Source: House of Commons Library, ABI, BCIS, EIOPA.

- Flood Re excludes commercial property and is legislated to end in 2039, when the market is intended to return to risk-reflective pricing. [House of Commons Library](#) (28 January 2020).
- The Flood Re levy raises 180 million pounds a year, and properties in flood-risk areas almost certainly face higher premiums outside the scheme. [House of Commons Library](#) (3 May 2023).
- There is no specific insurance for coastal erosion because it is treated as a virtual certainty, and 10,100 properties are at risk of loss to erosion. [House of Commons EFRA Committee](#) (20 March 2026).
- UK property insurers paid a record 6.1 billion pounds in 2025, with domestic flood claims up 38 percent. [Association of British Insurers](#) (17 February 2026).
- Average buildings insurance rose to 322 pounds a year in Q1 2025, up 10 percent year on year. [Association of British Insurers](#) (7 May 2025).
- BCIS forecasts UK building costs rising 13.1 percent and tender prices 15.5 percent over the five years to mid-2031. [BCIS \(RICS\)](#) (6 July 2026).
- Flood Re has a fixed 2039 exit after which the market must move to risk-reflective pricing, with around eight million homes in scope. [Insurance Business UK](#) (24 February 2026).
- Only about 25 percent of EU natural-catastrophe losses have been insured over recent decades, leaving a roughly 75 percent protection gap. [EIOPA](#) (16 April 2026).
- A record 2.65 billion pounds was invested in flood and coastal erosion risk management to March 2026, within a 10.5 billion programme. [Environment Agency](#) (30 June 2026).

- MDL Marinas is investing 6.35 million pounds across its UK marinas for 2025/26, including 822,620 pounds committed to dredging, showing the estate-cost trajectory. [Marina World](#) (18 December 2025).

Counter-argument

Risk-reduction works could keep the estate insurable and affordable past 2039. Flood Re's own transition guidance ties affordability to faster risk reduction, so defences and property-level resilience at the frontage could hold premiums down even after the scheme ends. The falsifiable test is whether the Club's buildings and estate policy renews without a material exclusion or excess step-change before 2030. Actors to watch: the ABI, Flood Re, and the Club's insurer and broker.

Weak signals to watch

- **WEAK SIGNAL** A risk-reflective repricing could arrive before 2039 as insurers pre-position. Would gain weight if a renewal adds a flood excess or coastal exclusion to the estate policy.
- **WEAK SIGNAL** Commercial-property flood cover could tighten faster than domestic. Would gain weight if a Solent marina reports a declined or loaded commercial renewal.

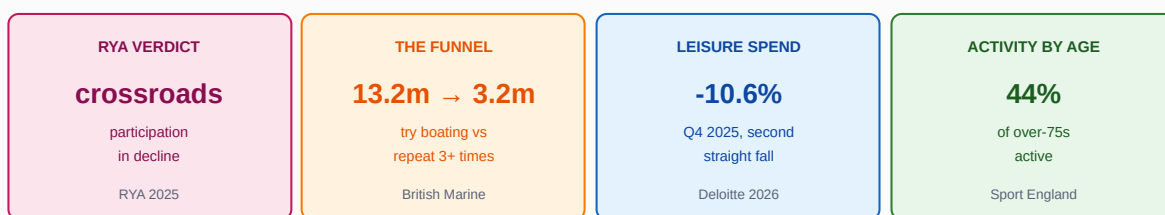
Decision link: Strategic Implications [3](#) and [1](#).

4. The Thinning Membership: ageing demographics and the discretionary squeeze on the club model

LONGER-RANGE

The membership base ages and thins beneath all of it. The RYA calls the sport at a crossroads with participation in decline, British Marine finds many adults try boating in a year but only a minority return regularly, and Deloitte records a second straight quarter of falling leisure spend. Activity drops sharply with age, and the Club's model rests on an older, discretionary-spend membership. The pathways to renew the base exist, but to 2040 the funnel has to be rebuilt for a different demographic rather than assumed to refill itself.

The thinning membership, in four numbers



The membership signal in four numbers. Source: RYA, British Marine, Deloitte, Sport England.

- The RYA warns UK sailing and boating are at a crossroads with participation in decline, citing about 100,000 members and a falling pipeline. [Royal Yachting Association](#) (6 November 2025).
- Sailing participation is in decline, and the RYA is surveying its 100,000-plus members to understand why fewer people are taking part. [Yachting Monthly](#) (17 November 2025).
- The RYA Director of Sport states UK sailing and boating participation is standing still, or starting to fall. [Practical Boat Owner](#) (4 December 2025).
- British Marine found 13.2 million UK adults tried a boating activity in 2022, but only 3.2 million took part three or more times. [Marine Industry News](#) (30 May 2023).
- The UK leisure, superyacht and small commercial marine industry generated 4.41 billion pounds of revenue in 2022-23, underlining the sector's economic weight. [British Marine](#) (17 April 2024).
- UK net spending on leisure fell for a second consecutive quarter to minus 10.6 percent in Q4 2025, with discretionary categories cut sharpest. [Deloitte UK](#) (13 February 2026).
- In 2024-25 activity fell sharply with age, with just 44.3 percent of over-75s active, underlining the demographic squeeze on an ageing model. [Sport England](#) (23 April 2026).
- The RYA British Sailing Youth Team fields about 75 young sailors across eight classes, running up to 40 programme days a year to feed the pathway. [Royal Yachting Association](#) (27 July 2026).
- The RYA Female Futures Group, linked to the Athena Pathway, targets a 50 percent increase in female coaching and management roles. [Royal Yachting Association](#) (11 June 2026).

Counter-argument

The post-pandemic dip could reverse as the RYA pathways mature. If the youth team, the Female Futures Group and adult-returner routes lift conversion, and the discretionary squeeze eases with the wider economy, the base stabilises and the members' model needs refreshing rather than rebuilding. The falsifiable test is whether Club membership and junior intake stabilise over two consecutive seasons. Actors to watch: the RYA, British Marine, and the Club's membership and sailing committees.

Weak signals to watch

- **WEAK SIGNAL** The adult-returner segment could outgrow the junior pipeline as the main funnel. Would gain weight if returner conversion outpaces junior intake for two seasons.
- **WEAK SIGNAL** The discretionary squeeze could push members from ownership to shared or club-owned boats. Would gain weight if berth demand softens while sailing-school demand holds.

Decision link: Strategic Implication [4](#).

Strategic Implications

Four decisions this cycle puts to the Club, each with a posture, an owner and the themes it draws on.

SI 1: Commission a to-2040 estate adaptation and capital plan

The [261mm sea-level allowance](#), saltmarsh [below 1,400 hectares](#) and a western-Solent risk rising [from 35 to 360 properties](#) make the Hamble frontage a dated capital task, not a maintenance line, and building costs are forecast up [13.1 percent to 2031](#). Plan pontoons, slipways, defences and property-level resilience against a 2040 waterline, phased and costed, rather than renewing to the old line. If a [funded shoreline scheme](#) reaches the frontage, the plan simply sequences around it.

Action: within this cycle, commission a to-2040 estate adaptation and capital plan with a phased cost profile and a defence-funding watch on the local coastal strategy.

Who gains: the Club that adapts the estate on a planned timetable, and the members who inherit a maintained frontage rather than an emergency bill.

DECIDE

Draws on Themes [1](#) and [3](#). Owner: Rear Commodore (House & Estate) / General Committee.

SI 2: Stand up a marina charging and low-carbon fuel pathway

Red diesel for propulsion now carries the [full 52.95 pence rate](#), the sector is tied to a [90 percent cut by 2040](#), and charging is arriving via [the Electric Seaway](#). Set a staged path: secure low-carbon fuel such as [HVO](#) through the existing bowser now, and scope marina [fast charging](#) for the point when the fleet turns over. If HVO reaches parity, the charging build-out can wait; if it does not, the groundwork is already done.

Action: this cycle, adopt a low-carbon fuel and charging roadmap with a decision gate tied to HVO price parity and local charging demand.

Who gains: the Club that sequences the energy transition deliberately, and the members who avoid a rushed, dearer retrofit later.

PREPARE

Draws on Theme [2](#). Owner: Marina & Facilities lead / House Committee.

SI 3: Re-underwrite the estate insurance and reserves against the 2039 Flood Re exit

Flood Re exits in 2039 and excludes commercial property, coastal erosion has [no specific cover](#), and UK claims hit a record [6.1 billion pounds](#). Review the estate policy for flood and coastal exposure now, model a risk-reflective premium path to 2039, and align the reserves and sinking-fund policy to it. If [faster risk reduction](#) holds premiums down, the reserve build is prudent headroom rather than a cost.

Action: within two cycles, obtain a forward view of the estate's flood and erosion insurability to 2039 and set a matching reserves and resilience-investment policy.

Who gains: the Treasurer who prices the 2039 transition early, and the members who are not surprised by a step-change in premium or excess.

PREPARE

Draws on Theme 3. Owner: Hon. Treasurer / Finance Committee.

SI 4: Rebuild the membership funnel for the 2040 demographic

The RYA calls the sport [at a crossroads](#), only about [a quarter of triallists](#) return regularly, and leisure spend fell [10.6 percent](#). Tie the Club's junior, adult-returner and female pathways to the RYA's [youth team](#) and [Female Futures Group](#), and track recruitment-to-retention as a board metric. If participation stabilises, the funnel is refreshed rather than rebuilt, but the work is the same either way.

Action: by the next cycle, publish a recruitment-to-retention funnel with named pathway owners and a season-on-season membership and junior-intake metric.

Who gains: the Club that builds its 2040 base deliberately, and the sailing programme that keeps its pipeline as the national one thins.

MONITOR

Draws on Theme 4. Owner: Vice Commodore / Membership & Sailing Committees.

Scenario Matrix

Four operating environments for the Club to 2040, generated by crossing two axes the evidence does not yet decide: whether the estate is adapted on a proactive, funded timetable or a reactive, deferred one, and whether the membership base is renewed and broadened or ages and thins. The matrix is a planning tool, not a forecast; the value sits in the indicators that would tip the Club from one cell to another.

ESTATE ADAPTATION (PROACTIVE AND FUNDED TO REACTIVE AND DEFERRED)

The Adapted Club

The best pairing: the estate is adapted on a planned, funded timetable and the membership is renewed and broadened. Defences, charging and a re-underwritten policy are sequenced ahead of need, and a wider 2040 base of members, families and returners carries them. Change absorbed, not survived.

Indicators: a funded frontage scheme lands; HVO or charging in place before the fleet turns; two seasons of stable-to-growing membership and junior intake.

Full Club, Fragile Ground

The membership renews and broadens, but the estate is adapted only reactively. A vibrant, younger club sits on a frontage that floods and reprices unpredictably, so member energy and subscription income are steadily absorbed by emergency estate and insurance bills rather than the sailing offer.

Indicators: membership and pathways strengthen while capital planning lags; rising insurance excess; ad hoc defence spend after weather events.

A Fine Club, Ageing

The estate is adapted on a funded, proactive plan, but the membership ages and thins. A well-maintained, resilient frontage serves a shrinking base, so the fixed cost of a first-class estate falls on fewer, older members and the subscription-per-head arithmetic tightens toward 2040.

Indicators: the capital plan and defences advance on schedule; membership drifts older; junior and returner conversion stays flat.

RENEWED

The Stranded Estate

The worst pairing: the estate is adapted late and the membership thins. A moving waterline sets the Club's timetable, defences and pontoons are renewed reactively at record build costs, insurance reprices as Flood Re exits, and a shrinking, ageing base carries a rising fixed-cost estate. The Club spends more to run less.

Indicators: no funded frontage scheme by 2035; an estate renewal declined or heavily loaded; two seasons of falling membership and junior intake.

THINNING

What We Are Not Planning For

Four scenarios held out of the plan because the evidence does not yet justify resourcing against them. Each carries the reinstatement trigger that would change that judgement.

Exclusion 1: Managed retreat or relocation of the Club estate

The [North Solent SMP](#) holds the line on the Hamble frontage and national defence [investment is at a record](#); the evidence points to adaptation in place, not abandonment, within the horizon. We are not planning for managed retreat or relocation of the estate to 2040.

Reinstatement trigger: *an SMP review reclassifying the Club's frontage to no active intervention, or the loss of a primary defence without a funded replacement.*

Exclusion 2: A collapse of the members'-club model

Participation is [in decline](#) but the base and its [economic weight](#) remain substantial, and renewal pathways are in train. We are not planning for a collapse of the members' model to 2040; we are planning to rebuild its funnel.

Reinstatement trigger: *two consecutive years of double-digit membership loss alongside a failure of the junior and returner pipeline to convert.*

Exclusion 3: A mandated all-electric fleet by 2040

The sector path is [technology-neutral](#), with [drop-in fuels](#) and slow fleet turnover; no measure mandates all-electric recreational craft. We are not planning for a compulsory all-electric fleet by 2040, while treating charging demand as a live prepare-item.

Reinstatement trigger: *a UK ban on new combustion leisure engines, or withdrawal of marina red-diesel and drop-in fuel supply.*

Exclusion 4: The estate becoming uninsurable today

The estate is [still insurable](#) now, with [Flood Re](#) running to 2039; the retreat is a direction of travel, not a present fact. We are not planning for immediate uninsurability, while re-underwriting against the 2039 exit.

***Reinstatement trigger:** an estate renewal declined outright, a coastal-flood exclusion added, or the Flood Re exit brought forward before 2039.*

Discussion Points

1. If the Hamble frontage is on moving ground, do we commission a to-2040 estate adaptation and capital plan now, or wait to see whether a funded shoreline scheme reaches us first?
2. **For the House Committee and marina:** do we secure low-carbon fuel and scope charging this cycle, or hold until HVO reaches price parity and the fleet turns over?
3. If Flood Re exits in 2039 and erosion has no cover, do we re-underwrite the estate policy and build reserves now, or treat today's cover as evidence the risk is distant?
4. **For the Treasurer and Finance Committee:** do we set an explicit reserves and sinking-fund path against a risk-reflective 2039 premium, or keep the current provision?
5. If the national pipeline is thinning, do we rebuild the recruitment-to-retention funnel around the 2040 member now, or assume the current base renews itself?

Source Confidence Register

39 verified sources across four themes. Tier 1 (governments, agencies, regulators, courts, multilateral bodies, national statistics, primary filings): 16. Tier 2 (think-tanks, institutional research, industry bodies, consultancies): 15. Tier 3 (specialist trade and quality press): 8. No Tier 4 sources are load-bearing. The set draws on six European and one French-language original alongside the UK base. Recency window is 180 days from the 30 July 2026 cycle; 24 sources six to twelve months or older are retained as structural anchors, foundational allowances, shoreline plans and baseline datasets, used for context rather than as fresh reads. 31 of the 39 sources (79%) sit at Tier 1 or 2; the source set was frozen at 2026-07-30. Every dated source was verified against genuinely fetched page text. Detect → Assess → Decide → Act.

Theme 1: The Moving Estate

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim
New Forest District Council / Environment Agency	T1	1 Dec 2010	The North Solent SMP sets shoreline policy for the River Hamble across three epochs and warns that rising sea levels increase risk to existing defences, with recreated coastal marsh taking 20 to 50 years to establish. <i>(structural anchor)</i>
Natural England	T1	17 Feb 2022	A recorded 1,784 ha of Solent saltmarsh has been lost, with UK saltmarshes eroding about 100 ha a year over 50 years and 90 percent of remaining Solent saltmarsh in unfavourable condition. <i>(structural anchor)</i>
Environment Agency (GOV.UK)	T1	27 May 2022	For the South East river basin district including the Solent, the higher-central sea-level allowance for the 2036-2065 epoch is 261 mm cumulative, with an upper-end allowance of 339 mm. <i>(structural anchor)</i>
University of Portsmouth	T1	1 Oct 2024	At Hackett's Marsh on the River Hamble the trial installed 107 coir rolls and over 330 stakes to slow saltmarsh erosion, within a target to restore 8 hectares of Solent saltmarsh in five years. <i>(structural anchor)</i>
Climate Change Committee	T1	30 Apr 2025	UK sea levels are projected around 10 to 30 cm higher than the 1981-2000 baseline by 2050, and roughly 8 million English properties could be at flood risk by 2050. <i>(structural anchor)</i>

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim
Environment Agency (GOV.UK)	T1	9 Jun 2026	Along the western Solent from Hurst Spit to Lymington, properties at risk are projected to rise from 35 today to 360 within 100 years without further adaptation.
Solent Forum	T2	1 Jan 2019	The Portsmouth tide gauge shows local sea-level rise rising from about 1.5 mm a year in the early 20th century to over 3 mm a year for 1993 to 2019, evidencing accelerating relative sea-level rise in the Solent. <i>(structural anchor)</i>
Tyndall Centre for Climate Change Research	T2	15 Jun 2022	An estimated 120,000 to 160,000 English coastal properties are at risk of relocation from sea-level rise from the 2050s, on top of 30,000 to 35,000 already identified. <i>(structural anchor)</i>
ABPmer for Solent Seascape	T2	28 Feb 2025	The Solent held over 3,000 ha of saltmarsh before the 1940s but has just under 1,400 ha today, more than half lost, and without intervention it could all but disappear within 100 to 200 years. <i>(structural anchor)</i>

Theme 2: The Zero-Carbon Wake

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim
HM Revenue & Customs (GOV.UK)	T1	7 Jul 2026	Diesel to propel private pleasure craft can no longer benefit from a reduced rate of duty and is charged at the full rate, and using red diesel for propulsion in Great Britain is unlawful absent a propulsion declaration.
ICOMIA	T2	15 Nov 2023	ICOMIA's lifecycle study finds sustainable marine fuels could decarbonise recreational boats by as much as 90 percent by 2035, while the global fleet of about 30 million boats turns over only around 2 percent a year. <i>(structural anchor)</i>
British Marine	T2	5 Sep 2024	Marina DC fast chargers can deliver up to 360 kW and an 80 percent charge in about 20 minutes, versus 8 to 10 hours for a full AC

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim
			charge, with load management across a site. <i>(structural anchor)</i>
Royal Yachting Association	T2	9 May 2025	The RYA states HVO cuts CO2 by around 90 percent but is currently more expensive to produce than mineral diesel due to low volumes, deterring marinas from stocking it. <i>(structural anchor)</i>
Grand View Research	T2	1 Jun 2025	The global electric-boat market was about USD 6.78 billion in 2024 and is projected to reach USD 14.09 billion by 2030, a 13.5 percent CAGR. <i>(structural anchor)</i>
European Boating Industry	T2	6 Nov 2025	The EU Sustainable Transport Investment Plan is the first EU transport strategy to include recreational craft, backing EUR 2.9 billion of support by 2027 to leverage over EUR 100 billion of investment by 2035. <i>(structural anchor)</i>
European Boating Industry	T2	1 May 2026	The EBI roadmap ties Europe's roughly 6.5 million recreational vessels and 10,000 to 20,000 marinas to the EU's 90 percent GHG-reduction target for 2040, noting HVO can cut lifecycle CO2 up to 90 percent as a drop-in fuel.
British Marine	T2	23 Jun 2026	Fuel suppliers to private pleasure craft must collect a propulsion declaration and charge the white-diesel rate of 52.95 pence per litre, some 46.47 pence above the rebated red-diesel rate.
METSTRADE (ICOMIA)	T3	25 Mar 2025	Sustainable drop-in fuels cut emissions 40 to 90 percent by boat type, while over 50 percent of a new boat's carbon footprint is embedded in manufacturing and supply chain. <i>(structural anchor)</i>
Plugboats	T3	28 Apr 2025	The 3.2 million pound UK Electric Seaway project completed 8 rapid electric-boat charging sites including Southampton Ocean Village, Lymington and Chichester on the Solent. <i>(structural anchor)</i>

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim
BoatIndustry.fr	T3	16 May 2026	France's Nautic Forum, on 28 and 29 May 2026, frames electrification of propulsion, eco-design and composite recycling as priorities, asking what recreational boating looks like at the 2035 horizon.

Theme 3: Uninsurable Ground

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim
House of Commons Library	T1	28 Jan 2020	Flood Re excludes commercial property and is legislated to end in 2039, when the intention is to return to a market-based system that reflects risk. <i>(structural anchor)</i>
House of Commons Library	T1	3 May 2023	The Flood Re levy raises 180 million pounds a year, and properties in areas at risk of flooding almost certainly face higher premiums, with the scheme ending in 2039. <i>(structural anchor)</i>
House of Commons EFRA Committee	T1	20 Mar 2026	There is no specific insurance for coastal erosion because it is treated as a virtual certainty, and 10,100 properties are at risk from coastal erosion over the next 80 years with no compensation route.
EIOPA	T1	16 Apr 2026	Only about 25 percent of natural-catastrophe losses in the EU have been insured over recent decades, leaving a roughly 75 percent protection gap as climate risk rises.
Environment Agency (GOV.UK)	T1	30 Jun 2026	A record 2.65 billion pounds was invested in flood and coastal erosion risk management to March 2026, within a 10.5 billion programme to 2036 intended to benefit 840,000 properties.
Association of British Insurers	T2	7 May 2025	Average buildings insurance rose to 322 pounds a year in Q1 2025, up 10 percent year on year, and the ABI called for at least 1 billion pounds a year for flood defences. <i>(structural anchor)</i>

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim
Association of British Insurers	T2	17 Feb 2026	UK property insurers paid a record 6.1 billion pounds in claims in 2025, with domestic flood claims up 38 percent and the average flood payout to homeowners up 60 percent to 30,000 pounds.
BCIS (RICS)	T2	6 Jul 2026	BCIS forecasts UK building costs rising 13.1 percent and tender prices 15.5 percent over the five years to mid-2031.
Marina World	T3	18 Dec 2025	MDL Marinas is investing 6.35 million pounds across its UK marinas for 2025/26, including 822,620 pounds committed to dredging plus pontoon and quay-wall replacement. (<i>structural anchor</i>)
Insurance Business UK	T3	24 Feb 2026	Flood Re has a fixed legislative exit in 2039 after which the market must move to risk-reflective pricing, with around eight million English properties projected to face some flood risk by 2050.

Theme 4: The Thinning Membership

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim
Royal Yachting Association	T1	6 Nov 2025	The RYA warns UK sailing and boating are at a crossroads with participation in decline, citing 100,000 members, 24,000 instructors and 250,000 volunteers. (<i>structural anchor</i>)
Sport England	T1	23 Apr 2026	In 2024-25 activity fell sharply with age, with just 44.3 percent of over-75s active versus higher rates among younger adults, underscoring the ageing-participation squeeze.
Royal Yachting Association	T1	11 Jun 2026	The RYA Female Futures Group, linked to the Athena Pathway, targets a 50 percent increase in female coaching and management roles and more active female racers by 2028.

Source	Tier	Date	Key claim
Royal Yachting Association	T1	27 Jul 2026	The RYA British Sailing Youth Team fields about 75 young sailors across eight classes, running up to 40 programme days a year to feed the racing pathway.
British Marine	T2	17 Apr 2024	The UK leisure, superyacht and small commercial marine industry generated 4.41 billion pounds of revenue in 2022-23 and a combined economic impact of 17.38 billion, supporting 753,838 FTE jobs. <i>(structural anchor)</i>
Deloitte UK	T2	13 Feb 2026	UK net spending on leisure fell for a second consecutive quarter to minus 10.6 percent in Q4 2025, with holidays cut sharpest as discretionary caution persists.
Marine Industry News (British Marine survey)	T3	30 May 2023	British Marine found 13.2 million UK adults tried a boating activity in 2022, but only 3.2 million took part three or more times, showing shallow repeat engagement. <i>(structural anchor)</i>
Yachting Monthly	T3	17 Nov 2025	Sailing participation is in decline, and the RYA, representing over 100,000 members, is surveying to understand why fewer people are getting afloat. <i>(structural anchor)</i>
Practical Boat Owner	T3	4 Dec 2025	The RYA Director of Sport states UK sailing and boating participation is standing still, or starting to fall. <i>(structural anchor)</i>

Claim-Fidelity Appendix: Analyst inferences and editorial framing

This briefing carries analyst-generated interpretations that go beyond what any single source asserts. They are named here so a reader can trace the confidence line and disagree productively.

Analytical inferences carried by the body prose

- "The estate, the fuel and the membership move at once" is an analyst frame linking four independently sourced threads, sea-level and saltmarsh data, fuel and decarbonisation mandates, the insurance retreat, and participation and demographic figures, into one pattern; no single source asserts the composite.
- Applying national and regional sea-level, saltmarsh and flood-risk figures to the Club's specific Hamble frontage is an analyst extrapolation: the sources establish the Solent and western-Solent trajectory, but the read that the Club's own frontage is a dated capital task is our inference, and is contested in the Theme 1 counter-argument.
- Treating red-diesel duty, the EU 2040 target and Solent charging as a single "the marina becomes an energy provider" decision synthesises separate developments into one Club-level choice; the case that HVO defers the build-out is signposted, not buried.
- Reading Flood Re's 2039 exit, record claims and rising build costs as a compounding "uninsurable at the edges" trajectory is an analyst characterisation; the estate is insurable today, and the counter-case that risk-reduction holds premiums is disclosed in the same theme.
- The judgement that the 2040 membership funnel must be rebuilt rather than refreshed is an interpretation of participation and demographic data, not a claim the sources make; the reversal case is carried in the Theme 4 counter-argument.

Editorial framing

The title "The Rising Solent, the Shifting Deck" is an editorial compression: it names the through-line that the estate, the fuel and the membership all move together to 2040, rather than asserting any single force in isolation. Consolidating four parallel threads under one "shifting deck" synthesis is an editorial choice that compresses independent analyses into a single decision-actionable pattern; readers who prefer to treat the four themes as separate registers can do so without losing any underlying claim. As the second edition, this report grades the May cycle's five near-term forces in the continuity ledger rather than setting a fresh baseline.

The Futures Wheel and the in-body figure SVGs are analyst constructions built from the sourced claims; they carry no separate source-register entry, so a claim or quantification flag on those elements is expected and disclosed here rather than being a provenance failure.